LeetCode & Platform Problems Structured According to Your DSA Roadmap

Based on comprehensive research and proven interview preparation strategies, here's your **complete problem-solving roadmap** aligned with your DSA project timeline:

Phase 1: Foundation Building (Months 1-2)

Daily Target: 2-3 problems

Week 1-2: Arrays & Basic Operations[1] [2]

Essential Easy Problems:

1. **Two Sum** (LeetCode 1) - Hash table introduction[3] [4]
2. **Contains Duplicate** (LeetCode 217) - Set operations[3]
3. **Best Time to Buy and Sell Stock** (LeetCode 121) - Single pass algorithm[3]
4. **Valid Anagram** (LeetCode 242) - Character counting[3]
5. **Move Zeroes** (LeetCode 283) - Two pointers technique[1]
6. **Remove Element** (LeetCode 27) - Array manipulation[1]
7. **Merge Sorted Array** (LeetCode 88) - Merging technique[1]

Key Patterns: Linear scanning, hash table usage, two pointers[5]

Week 3-4: Strings & Basic Algorithms[2] [1]

String Fundamentals:
8. **Valid Parentheses** (LeetCode 20) - Stack application[4] [3]
9. **Longest Common Prefix** (LeetCode 14) - String comparison[1]
10. **Fizz Buzz** (LeetCode 412) - Logic implementation[1]
11. **Student Attendance Record** (LeetCode 551) - String parsing[1]
12. **Calculate Digit Sum of String** (LeetCode 1945) - String processing[1]

Sorting & Searching:
13. **Binary Search** (LeetCode 704) - Classic binary search[2]
14. **Search Insert Position** (LeetCode 35) - Modified binary search[2]
15. **Pascal's Triangle** (LeetCode 118) - Array generation[1]

Week 5-8: Linked Lists & Stacks[1]

Linked List Basics:
16. **Reverse Linked List** (LeetCode 206) - Fundamental reversal[4] [3]
17. **Middle of Linked List** (LeetCode 876) - Fast/slow pointers[1]
18. **Merge Two Sorted Lists** (LeetCode 21) - Merging technique[3] [1]
19. **Linked List Cycle** (LeetCode 141) - Cycle detection[3]
20. **Remove Linked List Elements** (LeetCode 203) - Node removal[1]

Stack Applications:
21. **Min Stack** (LeetCode 155) - Stack with minimum tracking[1]
22. **Remove All Adjacent Duplicates** (LeetCode 1047) - Stack for duplicates[1]
23. **Evaluate Reverse Polish Notation** (LeetCode 150) - Stack calculations[1]

Queue Fundamentals:
24. **Implement Stack using Queues** (LeetCode 225)[1]
25. **Design Circular Queue** (LeetCode 622)[1]

Phase 2: Intermediate Skills (Months 2-4)

Daily Target: 3-4 problems

Week 9-12: Advanced Array Techniques[5] [3]

Two Pointers Pattern:[6] [5]
26. **3Sum** (LeetCode 15) - Multiple pointers[4] [3]
27. **Container With Most Water** (LeetCode 11) - Optimization problem[3]
28. **Remove Nth Node From End** (LeetCode 19) - Two pointers in linked list[3]

Sliding Window Technique:[6] [5]
29. **Longest Substring Without Repeating Characters** (LeetCode 3)[4] [3]
30. **Longest Repeating Character Replacement** (LeetCode 424)[3]
31. **Minimum Window Substring** (LeetCode 76) - Advanced sliding window[3]

Array Manipulation:
32. **Product of Array Except Self** (LeetCode 238)[4] [3]
33. **Maximum Subarray** (LeetCode 53) - Kadane's algorithm[3]
34. **Maximum Product Subarray** (LeetCode 152) - DP variation[3]

Week 13-16: Trees & Binary Search[3] [1]

Binary Tree Fundamentals:
35. **Maximum Depth of Binary Tree** (LeetCode 104) - Tree traversal[3]
36. **Same Tree** (LeetCode 100) - Tree comparison[3]
37. **Invert Binary Tree** (LeetCode 226) - Tree manipulation[3]
38. **Binary Tree Level Order Traversal** (LeetCode 102) - BFS[3]
39. **Validate Binary Search Tree** (LeetCode 98) - BST properties[3]

Advanced Tree Problems:
40. **Lowest Common Ancestor of BST** (LeetCode 235)[3]
41. **Serialize and Deserialize Binary Tree** (LeetCode 297) - Hard level[3]
42. **Binary Tree Maximum Path Sum** (LeetCode 124) - Hard level[3]

Binary Search Variations:[6]
43. **Search in Rotated Sorted Array** (LeetCode 33)[4] [3]
44. **Find Minimum in Rotated Sorted Array** (LeetCode 153)[3]

Phase 3: Advanced Intermediate (Months 4-6)

Daily Target: 4-5 problems

Week 17-20: Graph Algorithms[7] [3]

Graph Traversal:
45. **Number of Islands** (LeetCode 200) - DFS/BFS[4] [3]
46. **Clone Graph** (LeetCode 133) - Graph cloning[3]
47. **Pacific Atlantic Water Flow** (LeetCode 417) - Multi-source BFS[3]

Advanced Graph Problems:
48. **Course Schedule** (LeetCode 207) - Topological sort[3]
49. **Course Schedule II** (LeetCode 210) - Topological sort implementation
50. **Graph Valid Tree** (LeetCode 261) - Union-find application

Week 21-24: Dynamic Programming[7] [3]

Basic DP:[8]
51. **Climbing Stairs** (LeetCode 70) - Classic DP intro[4] [3]
52. **House Robber** (LeetCode 198) - Linear DP[3]
53. **House Robber II** (LeetCode 213) - Circular DP[3]

Intermediate DP:
54. **Coin Change** (LeetCode 322) - Unbounded knapsack[4] [3]
55. **Longest Increasing Subsequence** (LeetCode 300) - LIS pattern[3]
56. **Word Break** (LeetCode 139) - String DP[3]
57. **Combination Sum** (LeetCode 39) - Backtracking with DP[3]

Advanced DP:
58. **Unique Paths** (LeetCode 62) - 2D DP[3]
59. **Jump Game** (LeetCode 55) - Greedy/DP[3]
60. **Decode Ways** (LeetCode 91) - String DP variation[3]

Phase 4: FAANG Interview Preparation (Months 6-9)

Daily Target: 5-6 problems

Advanced Patterns & Hard Problems[8] [6]

Heap/Priority Queue:[7]
61. **Merge k Sorted Lists** (LeetCode 23) - Heap application[3]
62. **Top K Frequent Elements** (LeetCode 347) - Heap usage[3]
63. **Find Median from Data Stream** (LeetCode 295) - Two heaps pattern[3]

Intervals:[7]
64. **Merge Intervals** (LeetCode 56) - Interval processing[4] [3]
65. **Insert Interval** (LeetCode 57) - Interval insertion[3]
66. **Non-overlapping Intervals** (LeetCode 435) - Greedy intervals[3]

Advanced String/Trie:
67. **Implement Trie** (LeetCode 208) - Trie construction[3]
68. **Word Search** (LeetCode 79) - Backtracking in matrix[3]
69. **Word Search II** (LeetCode 212) - Trie + backtracking[3]

Bit Manipulation:[7]
70. **Number of 1 Bits** (LeetCode 191) - Bit counting[3]
71. **Counting Bits** (LeetCode 338) - DP with bits[3]
72. **Missing Number** (LeetCode 268) - XOR technique[3]

Phase 5: FAANG Interview Mastery (Months 9-12)

Daily Target: 6-8 problems

Company-Specific Hard Problems[9] [10]

Google-Style Problems:
73. **Text Justification** (LeetCode 68) - String formatting
74. **Regular Expression Matching** (LeetCode 10) - Advanced DP
75. **Median of Two Sorted Arrays** (LeetCode 4) - Binary search hard

Facebook/Meta-Style Problems:

- **Add Binary** (LeetCode 67) - String manipulation
- **Valid Number** (LeetCode 65) - State machine
- **Expression Add Operators** (LeetCode 282) - Backtracking

Amazon-Style Problems:[10]

- **Reorder Data in Log Files** (LeetCode 937) - Custom sorting
- **Prison Cells After N Days** (LeetCode 957) - Pattern recognition
- **Critical Connections in Network** (LeetCode 1192) - Tarjan's algorithm

Platform-Specific Recommendations

Primary Platforms (Daily Practice):

LeetCode: [11] [12]

- **Blind 75 List**: Core foundation problems [4] [3]
- **NeetCode 150**: Extended problem set for comprehensive prep [13] [14]
- **Company-specific tags**: Filter by Google, Amazon, Facebook for targeted practice

Alternative Platforms for Variety:

HackerRank: [15]

- Excellent for **algorithm implementation** practice
- Strong **mathematics and number theory** problems [2]
- Good for **step-by-step learning** progression

CodeChef: [16] [17]

- **C++ DSA roadmap** specifically designed [18]
- Structured difficulty progression
- Good for **competitive programming** mindset

GeeksforGeeks: [19] [2]

- **Comprehensive DSA tutorials** with explanations [20]
- **Practice problems** sorted by difficulty [2]
- Excellent **theoretical foundation** building

Weekly Practice Schedule

Daily Structure:

- **Morning (30-45 mins)**: 1-2 easy problems for consistency
- **Evening (60-90 mins)**: 1-2 medium/hard problems with deep analysis

Weekly Review:

- **Saturday**: Solve **5-7 random problems** from completed topics
- **Sunday**: **Pattern recognition** practice - identify problem types quickly

Monthly Assessment:

- **Week 4**: Complete a **full mock interview** set (4-5 problems in 3 hours)
- Track **problem-solving speed** and **accuracy** improvements

Pattern-Based Learning Strategy[5] [6]

Instead of random problem-solving, focus on **15 core patterns**:[21] [5]

1. **Sliding Window** → Problems 29-31
2. **Two Pointers** → Problems 26-28
3. **Fast & Slow Pointers** → Problems 17, 18
4. **Merge Intervals** → Problems 64-66
5. **Cyclic Sort** → Missing number patterns
6. **In-place Reversal** → Problems 16, 19
7. **Tree BFS** → Problems 38, 45
8. **Tree DFS** → Problems 35-37
9. **Two Heaps** → Problem 63
10. **Subsets** → Backtracking problems
11. **Modified Binary Search** → Problems 43-44
12. **Top K Elements** → Problems 61-62
13. **K-way Merge** → Problem 61
14. **Dynamic Programming** → Problems 51-60
15. **Topological Sort** → Problems 48-49

Progress Tracking Metrics

Phase Completion Goals:

- **Phase 1**: 25 problems, 90%+ easy problem accuracy
- **Phase 2**: 35 problems, 75%+ medium problem accuracy
- **Phase 3**: 35 problems, 60%+ medium problem accuracy
- **Phase 4**: 45 problems, 50%+ hard problem accuracy
- **Phase 5**: 50+ problems, FAANG interview ready

Success Indicators:

- **Speed**: Solve easy problems in <15 mins, medium in <35 mins
- **Pattern Recognition**: Identify problem type within 2-3 minutes
- **Code Quality**: Clean, bug-free first submissions 80%+ of the time

This structured approach ensures you **build strong fundamentals** while **progressively advancing** toward FAANG-level problem-solving capabilities, perfectly aligned with your DSA project roadmap.[22] [23] [8]

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